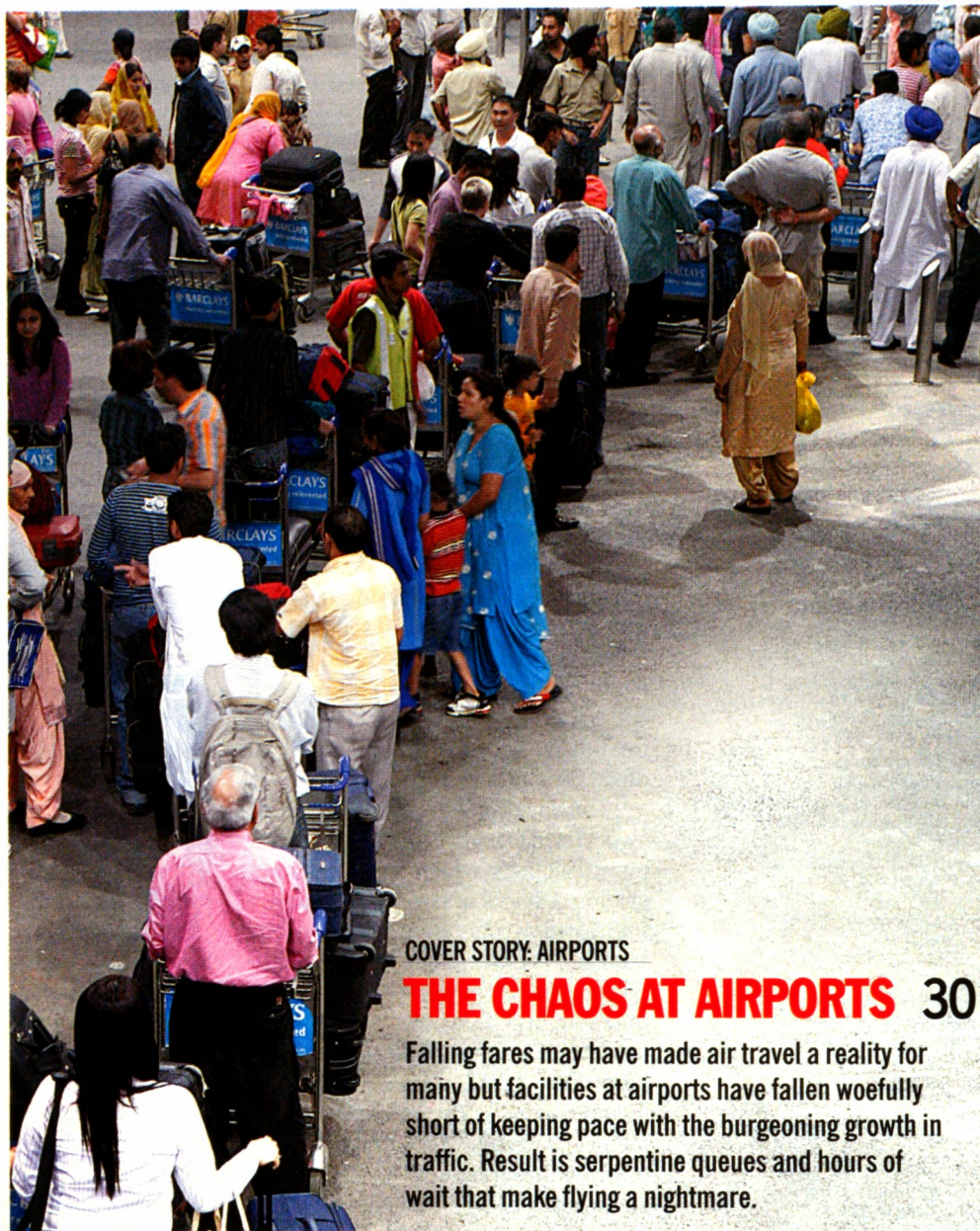


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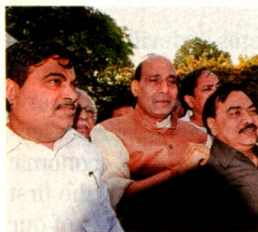


COVER STORY: AIRPORTS

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Falling fares may have made air travel a reality for many but facilities at airports have fallen woefully short of keeping pace with the burgeoning growth in traffic. Result is serpentine queues and hours of wait that make flying a nightmare.

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Grassroots leaders with a mass base are challenging the ways of the central high command in a party that was once known for its cadre-discipline and internal democracy.

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Inside China, there is growing alarm over the negative publicity following the torch. The Olympics event was to be its showpiece but domestic realities, among other issues, could spoil the party.



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